

I love the television formatting choice here. Structuring it with the official **"ACT I"** title card immediately following the cold open places it squarely in that classic 1960s Quinn Martin production style. It anchors the story right back into the heavy, unmoving silence of that foyer. Here is the refined, complete sequence for the series premiere of *The Captive*:

THE CAPTIVE

Season 1, Episode 1: "The Stafford Standard"

Prologue & Act I Setup

[FADE IN]

EXT. HIGHWAY OUTSKIRTS - NIGHT (HIGH-CONTRAST BLACK AND WHITE)

The frame is harsh, grainy, and full of deep shadows. A figure is running alongside a stark concrete barrier under the glare of distant, sweeping headlights.

AUDIO: The driving, frantic brass of Pete Rugolo's main theme builds to a screaming crescendo. The brass section is sharp, mimicking a racing heartbeat—urgent and unrelenting. The camera tracks him as he cuts across a gravel ditch, his breath ragged, the gray trench coat caught in the wind. The headlights behind him sweep across the screen, blinding the lens.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (*William Conrad's deep, authoritative baritone*)

"The chase is over. For four years, Dr. Richard Kimble was a fugitive from injustice. For four years, he ran from the shadow of the gallows... toward an elusive truth. Now, the truth has been found. The real killer is dead. The nightmare of the road is finished... but for Richard Kimble, a new sentence begins."

EXT. SUBURBAN STREET - STAFFORD, OHIO - NIGHT

The music hits its highest, most frantic peak as Kimble reaches a quiet, tree-lined residential street. He stops under the soft, static glow of a streetlamp. He isn't looking behind him anymore. He walks up a neat brick walkway toward a dark, ordinary front porch. He pulls a brass key from his pocket. His hands are steady, but the motion is slow, almost mechanical.

He inserts the key. Turns it.

INT. THE KIMBLE HOME - FOYER - CONTINUOUS

The door opens. Kimble steps inside, closing the heavy wooden door behind him. He turns the deadbolt.

AUDIO: The driving brass horns **CUT ABRUPTLY** on the click of the lock.

The silence is immediate, heavy, and jarring. After a two-second beat of absolute quiet, the iconic, melancholic woodwind and muted string interlude creeps in—slow, low, and mournful. Kimble stands in the dark foyer. The hallway light catches the deep lines in David Janssen's face. He doesn't drop his leather bag. He just stands there, staring at the empty living room, trapped in the quiet.

HARD FLASH TO WHITE:

Across the screen, the stark, blocky letters hit like a gavel:

THE CAPTIVE

[FADE TO BLACK]

MAIN TITLE CREDITS ROLL (UNDER THE LOW STRING INTERLUDE):

- STARRING DAVID JANSSEN

- PRODUCED BY QUINN MARTIN

[FADE IN]

TITLE CARD (Stark white text on a solid black background):

ACT I

[FADE OUT]

[FADE IN]

INT. THE KIMBLE HOME - FOYER - NIGHT

The scene returns exactly where we left it. The string interlude fades out completely, leaving only the ambient, hollow silence of the house.

Kimble is still standing in the exact same spot by the door. The coat is still buttoned. The bag is still gripped tightly in his right hand. He doesn't move. He looks down at the floorboards, then up at the staircase, completely paralyzed by the lack of a pursuit.

The camera slowly pushes in on David Janssen's face—exhausted, hyper-alert, and entirely out of place in his own home.

That "ACT I" drop brings the heavy weight of reality right back down. He isn't running to the next town; the episode is starting, and he has nowhere left to flee.

Now that he's standing there in the dark foyer at the start of Act I, what is the very first move he makes to break the stillness?